

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 315

By McNally

A RESOLUTION to honor the reopening of the historic Loudon County Courthouse.

WHEREAS, we take great pride in recognizing those venerable public buildings that stand as beloved historic landmarks in their communities; and

WHEREAS, one such institution is the historic Loudon County Courthouse, which will celebrate its unveiling and grand reopening on April 26, 2025, as it returns to public service six years after a fire ravaged the building on April 23, 2019; and

WHEREAS, the devastating fire took several hours to extinguish and led to over \$1 million in damages, resulting in the need for extensive restoration and renovation of the great building, with some changes made for efficiency, aesthetics, and public safety; and

WHEREAS, the historic Loudon County Courthouse was originally constructed in 1872 by J. Wesley and Ira Napoleon Clarke of Sweetwater for a cost of \$14,200, according to the Loudon County TNGenWeb Project; and

WHEREAS, it has been of the utmost importance to the community and the lovers of Tennessee's treasured heritage that the courthouse was rebuilt and restored to its former glory, with the bones of the structure used in its rebuilding; and

WHEREAS, the historic Loudon County Courthouse has served the citizens of Loudon County with justice and honor for 147 years, and it is fitting that this exemplary public institution be recognized on this truly special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and celebrate the grand reopening of the

historic Loudon County Courthouse and extend our congratulations and commendations to the community and all involved for a job well done.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.